

THE ALLOTMENT NEWS

Newsletter of the Hebbal Community Garden — Issue 14, July

The monsoon has been kind

Three straight weeks of steady rain and, for once, nothing washed out. The raised beds along the north wall held up perfectly, which vindicates the gravel base that took four Sundays to lay. The lower plots did flood briefly on the 14th, but drained by the following morning with no lasting damage.

Tomatoes are ahead of schedule. Beans are behind. Nobody can explain the beans.

What is ready to pick

- Tomatoes — plots 3, 4, 7 and 11. Take what you can use.
- Spinach and amaranth — cut, do not pull, and it will come again.
- Chillies — plot 9, and there are far too many. Please help.
- Curry leaves — the big tree by the gate, as always.
- Bananas — not yet. Two more weeks. Stop asking.

Jobs for August

- Re-stake the trellis on the east side before the next heavy wind.
- Compost bay two is ready to turn — it needs four people and an hour.
- The tap at the far end drips. Someone with a wrench, please.
- Label the seedling trays. We have three unmarked trays and no idea what is in them.
- Repaint the shed door. Paint is in the shed, which is a problem we noticed too late.

Seed swap — Sunday the 9th

Bring whatever you have saved, labelled if possible and guessed at if not. Last time we ended up with eleven envelopes of something that turned out to be okra, so a pencil and a bit of tape go a long way. Tea and something baked from 10am. The swap itself starts at 10:30 and is usually over by noon.

A note on the cat

The ginger cat that has been sleeping in the seedling frames is not, as far as anyone can establish, anybody's cat. It has been named four different things by four different people. It does not answer to any of them. It does keep the squirrels off the sunflowers, so it stays.

Next working party: Sunday 9th, 8am until it gets too hot. Gate code is on the noticeboard. Bring your own gloves.